

the USA and turning around businesses back home, Sreeram believes the exposure that India has given him has enabled him to be a good problem solver and learn the art of damage control. He believes in working with companies and bosses that have a strong value system. A couple of jobs where he did not work for long was more due to value system mismatch than anything else. "On the other hand, I had some great mentors along the way and always will cherish the time I worked with Mr Sundar Ram at the Rane Group, and Mr Santhanam at Saint Gobain," Sreeram says.

Romantic at heart

Hiding behind his professional getup is an individual who is probably a romantic at heart. "My wife and I went to Rome and Paris for our 25th marriage anniversary. This was despite the fact that we had already seen Europe three years earlier along with our twin daughters. I must add that this anniversary vacation was a complete surprise from me to my wife. I bought the tickets without letting her know and surprised her a few days before the travel," says Sreeram with a smile.

"We spent our anniversary in Florence and got to eat some great local food. The only regret was we couldn't make Venice on that trip and had to be satisfied with Rome and The Vatican but with our own exclusive tour guide. We said we would soon visit Venice with the whole family, but the pandemic has changed all our plans! We did make it to Dubai three years later for our 28th and even spent the night at the Atlantis Hotel in Dubai."

Sreeram says, he always enjoyed



Snorkeling in Phuket

Smita Patil's portrayals in movies, but his favourite was always Rekha. A regular with Hollywood movies, he makes sure not to miss any movie that stars Leonardo DiCaprio or Tom Cruise. Of the actresses from Hollywood, Meryl Streep happens to be his favourite leading lady due to her simple acting style and becoming one with the character she portrays.

On family front, Sreeram wants to see his twin daughters soar higher in their research in bio-tech. He is thankful to his wife and to his father for standing by him and taking care of the home front while he pursued his career aspirations and his professional journey.

"Right from 2001, I have been heading one business or the other. My dad and my wife have been as supportive as they can be and have never let me digress from my work. All the professional goals that I have been able to achieve in life are because of them," says Sreeram.

He adds, "I am often quite hard on myself. I find myself thinking if I have ever been a good father, a good husband, a good son, or even a good employee. The only solace I give myself on the work side is that I have been very disciplined. The flip side of that is expecting the people working around me to have the same level of discipline and penchant for perfection."

Sreeram plans in the longer term to become a coach and mentor to the younger and aspiring leaders and give back as much as he can to help them achieve their goals. He is also of the view that leaders with entrepreneurial mindset work by the same yardsticks, whether they are employed by an organisation or they are working for their own venture.

One of his blogs about leadership reads, "Leadership is not about titles but it is about followership. It needs an attitude and a certain attribute. Go forth and be a leader from today. The world needs more of them." **EFY**

Some less known facts about Dr Sreeram Srinivasan

Favourite Actor: Sharukh Khan and Amitabh Bachchan

Favourite Food: Anything North Indian, especially Rajma Chawal

Favourite Actress: Rekha, Meryl Streep, Smita Patil

Favourite Author: Robert Ludlum, Malcolm Gladwell

Favourite Movie: A Few Good Men

Favourite Musician: Ravindra Jain and Salil Chaudhary

Favourite Book: A Stone For Danny Fisher, Blink!, Outliers, The Osterman Weekend, Freakonomics series

Favourite Cartoon: TinTin, Asterix, Amar Chitra Katha

Cars or Bikes: Simple cars like automatic Brio (suits our roads and traffic)

Coffee or Tea: Filter coffee at home and Starbucks' Dark Italian Roast

Belief: One has to be truly blessed to be born and live in India!